MONKEY-TAILED SKINK

Corucia zebrata

1. What can it see, hear, or feel?
Its flickering tongue tastes the air, its eyes see in dim light, and it senses movement on branches.

2. Where does it live — and why?
It lives high in island forest trees, where its gripping tail holds on as it reaches for leaves.

3. How does it send messages?
It hisses as a warning, bites if ignored, and rubs scent on branches its family group shares.

4. What does it do when something changes?
When threatened, it grips tight with its tail, turns sideways, and hisses at the approaching danger.

5. How does it learn?
Young skinks stay in the family group for months, and adults protect them as they learn the trees.

6. How does it have babies?
A mother carries one big baby inside her body and gives birth live — unusual for a lizard.

7. What are its limits?
It needs special forest plants, so when trees are cut, both its food and its home disappear.

8. What does this teach us?
A lizard that lives in a family group teaches us that reptiles can cooperate too.

WHY IS THIS ANIMAL HERE?

Monkey-tailed skinks live only in the Solomon Islands, high in rainforest trees.

Their forests are being logged for timber export.

They are also heavily collected for the international pet trade.

When its habitat shrinks:

- they give birth to just one large baby at a time
- losing even a few adults hurts the whole population
- they are listed as one of the most threatened skinks in the world

This place is not their natural home, but it can help keep the species alive.

THINK ABOUT THIS

If you stayed with your family for years, what would you want them to teach you?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.

SCAN TO LEARN MORE